ZOOPLUS

Interview Planning

Education

- Bachelor’s in Electronic Engineering
- MSc in Machine Learning
- PhD in Data Science & Statistical Modeling: Unsupervised learning (How to train the models when there is not labeled data)

Industrial Experience

2017 – Intelligent Electronic Solutions

- C++ / Object-Oriented developer

2020–2021 – Machine Learning Engineer at SUPSI-DTI (Switzerland)

- Developed deep learning pipelines for object detection systems

2021–2024

While working on my PhD, I also collaborated with xFarm as a consultant (20–30%)

- Implemented and fine-tuned production AI systems

Main challenges:

- Lack of data
- Generation of synthetic data to improve AI systems
- Data augmentation

2024– until now

- Developed multi-agent and agent-based orchestration frameworks for agronomic applications
- **Applications included:**
  - Recommendations systems
  - Monitoring systems
- **Technologies used:**
- LangGraph
- LangChain
- Later, we decided to continue working with Google ADK (a framework for agent/tool-use APIs).

Challenges handled:

- Hallucinations
- Language switching for users
- Unexpected agent behavior

Personal Interest

Doing that developed a strong interest in language-related AI topics in general, including:

- Structure, Knowledge base, ontologies : Really improvement to AI systems for correct acceleration in development lifecycle
- LLMs
- RAG systems

In my free time, I enjoy experimenting with:

- Fine-tuning models
- Creating my own agents
- Using Ollama and Hugging Face
- Exploring local LLM deployment and adaptation

First of all I love pets
"From my perspective, the biggest AI opportunities at zooplus are around personalization, search/discovery, forecasting, and production-grade LLM systems.
The key challenge is not just model performance but integrating these reliably into a large-scale e-commerce platform and tying them to measurable business KPIs."
The possibility to grow up and team collaboration

zooplus is seeking an AI Engineer to embed AI across the software development lifecycle.
The role involves implementing AI-driven accelerators, developing extensions, and collaborating with teams for AI adoption.
The company promotes a hybrid working model and offers various benefits.

Strong programming experience in Java, Python, or Kotlin; hands-on experience with LLM integration;
knowledge of RAG, embeddings, and vector databases;
 experience with Docker, Kubernetes, and Terraform;
familiarity with intelligent test automation; and understanding of AI-augmented architecture patterns.

I Care Deeply I own my choices, embrace change, and turn challenges into exciting chances to grow.
Career_Page-25Purpose.png I'm Brave You own your actions, embrace change, and turn challenges into opportunities to grow.
Career_Page-06Thrive.png I Thrive in Teams I believe in the magic of teamwork, sharing ideas freely and chasing shared goals together.
Career_Page-03Clear.png I Keep Things Clear I cut through complexity, simplify processes, and find smart ways to get things done.

Career_Page-04Open.png I Stay Open I listen, welcome feedback, and celebrate diverse perspectives to build trust and collaboration.
Career_Page-38InternalMovement.png I'm Purpose-Led I care about pets and people making every day count with meaningful impact.

Leadership
This step applies to roles with people management responsibilities. You'll meet a member of our People & Culture team (aka Human Resources) and an experienced leader from our organisation. The conversation will focus on your leadership experience and include exploratory questions about your approach to leadership and how you would handle specific people-management scenarios.

Smart Interview Framing / Talking Points

You can mention that you understand zooplus' AI transformation appears focused on:

1. **Agentic commerce experiences**
2. **Personalized customer journeys**
3. **AI-powered internal engineering productivity**
4. **Operational optimization through predictive systems**

This shows business awareness.

"Why zooplus / Why this role?":
I'm particularly interested in helping transform AI for robust production systems —
building scalable, reliable models/services that improve customer experience and internal efficiency."
is that AI here is directly tied to large-scale business impact.
In a platform serving millions of customers, improvements in recommendation quality, search relevance, forecasting, or AI-powered workflows can create measurable revenue and operational gains.

"From my perspective, the biggest AI opportunities at zooplus
are around personalization, search/discovery, forecasting, and production-grade LLM systems.
It is not just model performance but integrating these into a large-scale e-commerce platform

6. Bonus: Good Questions You Can Ask Them

These will make you sound senior/strategic:

- "What AI systems are already in production today?"
- "What are the biggest technical bottlenecks in your AI platform?"

- "Where is the biggest gap between experimentation and deployment?"
- "How do you currently evaluate AI success—business KPIs, offline

metrics, online experiments?"
- "How mature is your experimentation/A-B testing infrastructure?"
- "What is the balance between classical ML and LLM-based systems in your roadmap?"

Key Performance Indicator (KPI)

Challenge	Why It Matters for zooplus	Possible AI / Technical Solutions	How You Could Contribute
Personalization & Recommendations	Increases basket size, conversion, retention, subscription renewal	Collaborative filtering, deep recommender systems, product/user embeddings, session-based recommendations, ranking models	Apply representation learning / embedding methods; improve recommendation quality; design scalable retrieval/ranking pipelines
Search Relevance & Product Discovery	Poor search directly reduces conversion and frustrates users	Semantic search, vector search, query understanding, typo correction, rerankers, multilingual NLP	Build embeddings/ search pipelines; improve multilingual retrieval; optimize ranking relevance
Cold Start Problem (new users/products)	New products and users lack behavioral data	Content-based recommendation, metadata embeddings, hybrid recommenders, zero-shot/LLM enrichment	Use unsupervised/ representation learning to infer similarity from product metadata/ content

Demand Forecasting & Inventory Planning	Overstock/understock hurts margins and customer satisfaction	Time-series forecasting, probabilistic forecasting, reorder prediction, supply-chain optimization models	Develop forecasting pipelines; improve predictive uncertainty estimation; monitor forecast drift
Pricing Optimization	Small pricing improvements can have large revenue impact	Dynamic pricing models, elasticity estimation, competitor-price monitoring, reinforcement learning / bandits	Build experimentation frameworks; optimize pricing strategies with causal/ML models
Customer Retention / Churn Prediction	Repeat purchases are core in pet food e-commerce	Churn models, reorder prediction, CLV estimation, personalized retention campaigns	Create predictive lifecycle models; segment users for targeted interventions
LLM / Agentic Commerce Systems	Enables AI assistants, internal copilots, automation	RAG pipelines, tool-calling agents, prompt/version management, evaluation frameworks, guardrails	Productionize LLM systems; improve reliability, observability, and evaluation pipelines
Customer Support Automation	Reduces support cost and response time	AI chatbots, ticket classification, agent assist, summarization systems	Build retrieval-based support copilots; optimize latency/cost/accuracy tradeoffs

Fraud / Abuse Detection	Protects revenue and operational integrity	Anomaly detection, graph models, behavioral ML, risk scoring	Apply anomaly detection / unsupervised methods to identify suspicious behavior
Experimentation / A/B Testing Infrastructure	Needed to prove AI business value	Online experimentation platforms, metric dashboards, causal inference tooling	Design robust evaluation pipelines connecting model metrics to business KPIs
Production ML Reliability	Models fail if not monitored/ maintained	MLOps, drift detection, monitoring, CI/ CD for models, feature stores	Bring production ML engineering rigor; improve deployment and observability
Legacy System Integration	AI must work with existing commerce stack	API-first model serving, microservice integration, feature pipelines, scalable infra	Help bridge research/ prototyping into maintainable production services